



Alex Singla

Senior Partner, Co-Lead of QuantumBlack

1926

Founded

~40,000

People

~25,000

AI agents

~40%

Work that is AI

~\$16B

Revenue (2023)

01 Who You're Meeting

Alex Singla — Senior Partner, Co-Lead of QuantumBlack, McKinsey & Company.

In role: Global co-leader of QuantumBlack

Today: Leads QuantumBlack globally — the 1,700-person AI and advanced analytics unit behind roughly 40% of McKinsey's work — advising CEOs and boards on AI transformations, operations and value creation.

A senior partner based in Chicago whose defining theme is the gap between pilots and production. He built QuantumBlack from an acquisition into a recognised global AI practice, broadening it across industries and geographies and positioning it at the intersection of AI, data engineering and business transformation. His own practice focus is financial services and insurance. He states repeatedly that change management and capability building must be core elements of every transformation rather than add-ons — which is the same argument the 10-20-70 framing makes at BCG, and the one most AI programmes get wrong.

Career: Senior Partner; Global Leader, QuantumBlack, AI by McKinsey, McKinsey & Company; Senior Partner, Chicago — digital, analytics, operations and enterprise transformation, McKinsey & Company

The company: The most prestigious strategy firm, and the one making the most aggressive claims about restructuring itself around AI. QuantumBlack, a 1,700-person unit, now drives initiatives accounting for roughly 40% of the firm's work — while headcount has fallen more than 10% and about 10% of non-client-facing staff are being cut over 18 to 24 months.

What they sell: Strategy, operations, organisation and technology consulting, with QuantumBlack as the AI and advanced analytics arm and Lilli as the proprietary internal AI tool.

02 Where The Company Sits

McKinsey is doing publicly what most of this peer set is doing quietly: shrinking the support base, holding or growing the client-facing pyramid, and filling the gap with agents. Sternfels' stated goal is every employee paired with one or more agents, and he has said he expects agent count to match human headcount.

03 Talking Points

- The operational counterpart at McKinsey for anything AI — Sternfels runs the firm, Singla runs the capability.
- His stated position is that adoption and capability building, not modelling, decide outcomes. That aligns with how a portfolio programme should be scoped.
- Financial services is his own sector; infrastructure is not. Ask directly for asset-heavy references rather than assuming transferability.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- No revenue disclosure at all — nothing in the AI narrative can be tested against financial performance
- Headcount fell more than 10% in eighteen months, and a further ~10% cut to non-client-facing staff is under way
- Revenue growth reportedly flatlined before the restructuring, which is the context the AI story sits inside

04 GIP Context

GIP: No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. McKinsey works extensively with private equity and infrastructure owners, so an existing relationship at deal or fund level is plausible and would not be public. Check internally before assuming a clean slate.

BlackRock: None publicly disclosed.

Others at McKinsey & Company: Bob Sternfels (Global Managing Partner)

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